I formed a team to do research for writing the army doctrine. It was evolved keeping in mind the lessons learnt in previous wars, including Kargil and the recently concluded Operation Parakram. We had frequent review meetings and discussed various issues that arose. My experience of Exercise Poorna Vijay, Operation Parakram, and the seminar on heavy breakthrough helped me in formulating the doctrine for offensive operations in the plains and desert. It also addressed our concerns in the mountains. This doctrine was a visionary document in which the futuristic challenges were analysed and we talked of fighting the future war. By the end of the year, we had the draft of the document ready. After considerable deliberations, it was approved and released the next year by the army chief.

All important training institutions of the army came under the Army Training Command. Therefore, I had a lot of travelling to do. We reviewed and published a book on leadership and another on training in the Indian Army, called *Quest for Excellence*. During the annual training conference in 2003, I laid great emphasis on information technology, geographical information systems, aerial and satellite imagery, communications and night fighting capabilities. We developed indigenous war gaming models based on computers and began training officers at unit level in a facility in Delhi Cantonment. I also encouraged the development of simulators for gunnery, driving, aviation and in other applications. Where necessary, we made our bids for import of such equipment. We raised a simulator division in the Electronic and Mechanical Engineering College at Secunderabad. Computerized war gaming and simulators reduced the need for exercises in the field and enhanced the life of equipment due to less wear and tear, thereby generating a lot of savings. Citing the example of Operation Desert Storm, the US campaign in Iraq during 1991–92, I exhorted officers to study the use of high technology, especially surveillance, acquisition and destruction of targets, with precision-guided munitions, so as to be able to obtain a decisive result in the shortest possible time frame, and with the minimum casualties.